

## China: NBS manufacturing PMI weakened sharply

- *July NBS PMIs showed broad weakness across both manufacturing and non-manufacturing*
- *Mfg PMI output component slipped into contraction, raising downside risks to sustaining June's IP rebound*
- *New orders weakened, although exports may have recovered later in the month after port disruptions*
- *Politburo signaled faster fiscal deployment, while incremental easing remains possible if growth softens*

NBS PMIs showed broad-based weakening across both production and demand, and across both manufacturing and non-manufacturing, pointing to a soft start to 3Q. The output PMI slipped just below the 50 threshold, raising risks around sustaining [June's IP rebound](#), while domestic demand weakened more sharply. This likely increases pressure on fiscal execution, as emphasized at yesterday's July Politburo meeting. Price components continued to ease, potentially reviving deflation concerns further ahead.

NBS manufacturing PMI surprised to the downside in July, falling 1.1pts to 49.2 (vs. JPM: 50.8; consensus: 50.1). The output PMI dipped below the 50-threshold for the first time in five months, dropping 1.5pts to 49.9. While PMI signals do not always track hard activity data, this suggests the pace of June's industrial production rebound (1.0% m/m sa) may not be sustained, in part due to the traditional production off-season for some manufacturing segments. Despite the July weakness, business sentiment remained upbeat, with the future output PMI continuing to expand (54.1).

Demand components also weakened, led by domestic demand. The new orders PMI fell by 2.7pts to 48.5, a larger decline than new export orders (-0.5pt), and both are in the contractionary territory. Export orders PMI slowed to 49.6, in line with our mid-July [port tracking](#) as typhoon Bavi disrupted port operations, but there could be some recovery in the later part of the month that might not be captured by the survey. We will wait for the RatingDog PMI due next Monday, focused on export-oriented firms, to provide more clarity. Fewer new orders have prompted a decrease in purchase quantity and backlogs of work, keeping employment at a subdued level.

Despite the recent re-escalation in the Middle East, input prices grew at a slower pace, with input price PMI easing 1.0pt to 53.2. However, output price continued to decline, down 0.4pt to 47.8, indicating weak downstream pricing power and limited pass-through ability. Together with still-soft domestic demand, deflation concerns may reemerge.

Non-manufacturing PMI also slipped—down 1.2pts to 49.0, the lowest since end-2022. Services PMI declined 1.1pts to 49.3, mainly dragged by wholesale trade and financial services. This was partly offset by summer tourism demand, as PMIs for air transport, accommodation, and culture/sports/entertainment rose notably from the prior month. Meanwhile, the construction PMI contracted more sharply to 47 amid the ongoing housing downturn and potential disruptions from summer rainfall and heat. This points to uncertainty around the fixed asset investment recovery heading into 2H, ahead of local leadership turnover.

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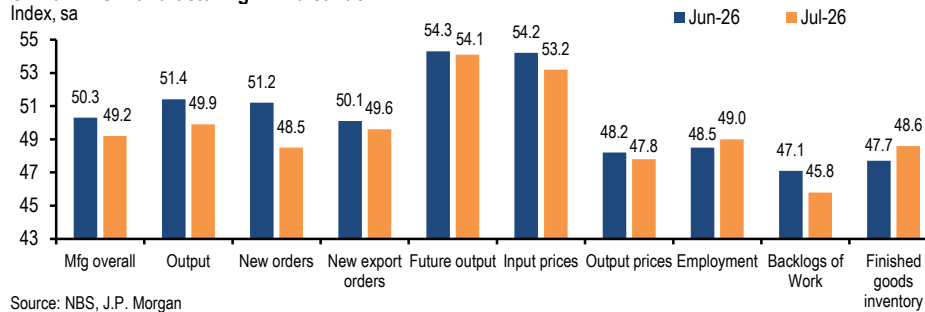
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## Broad PMI weakness puts pressure on fiscal execution

The softer-than-expected July NBS PMI adds some near-term uncertainty to our constructive 2H growth view. While PMI signals do not always align with hard activity data, we see downside risk to July production momentum following June's rebound, with domestic demand continuing to be a constraint amid softer new orders and construction activities. This should put greater pressure on fiscal policy execution—particularly faster fiscal spending and accelerated deployment of bond proceeds—to support investment and consumption, as emphasized in yesterday's [July's Politburo](#). Additional easing remains on the table, but is likely to be data-dependent and contingent on the degree of any 3Q slowdown. Externally, while the Middle East situation remains highly uncertain, we see that the peak influence may gradually fade as economies adapt to the turbulent energy situation. Exports should continue to outperform, riding on the global IP/AI upcycle, even as tariff-related risks are rising. We will look to next week's RatingDog PMIs and trade report for confirmation.

China: NBS manufacturing PMI breakdown



Source: NBS, J.P. Morgan

China: NBS PMI

Index, sa

|                          | 2025 | Mar-26 | Apr-26 | May-26 | Jun-26 | Jul-26 |
|--------------------------|------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Mfg overall              | 49.6 | 50.4   | 50.3   | 50.0   | 50.3   | 49.2   |
| Output                   | 50.9 | 51.4   | 51.5   | 51.2   | 51.4   | 49.9   |
| New orders               | 49.9 | 51.6   | 50.6   | 49.9   | 51.2   | 48.5   |
| New export orders        | 47.4 | 49.1   | 50.3   | 48.6   | 50.1   | 49.6   |
| Future output            | 53.5 | 53.4   | 54.5   | 53.9   | 54.3   | 54.1   |
| Input prices             | 50.8 | 63.9   | 63.7   | 60.5   | 54.2   | 53.2   |
| Output prices            | 47.5 | 55.4   | 55.1   | 51.9   | 48.2   | 47.8   |
| Employment               | 48.2 | 48.6   | 48.8   | 48.6   | 48.5   | 49.0   |
| Backlogs of Work         | 45.2 | 47.1   | 46.2   | 46.8   | 47.1   | 45.8   |
| Finished goods inventory | 47.6 | 46.7   | 47.5   | 49.3   | 47.7   | 48.6   |
| Order to inventory ratio | 1.05 | 1.10   | 1.07   | 1.01   | 1.07   | 1.00   |
| Non manufacturing (NBS)  | 50.2 | 50.1   | 49.4   | 50.1   | 50.2   | 49.0   |

Source: NBS, J.P. Morgan.

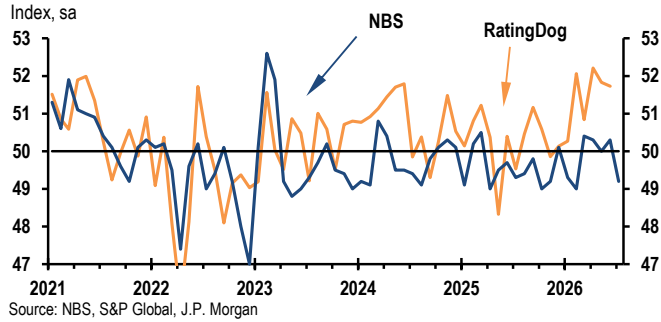
Note: green: >50 & improving; light green: >50 but declining; yellow: <50 but improving; red: <50 & declining.

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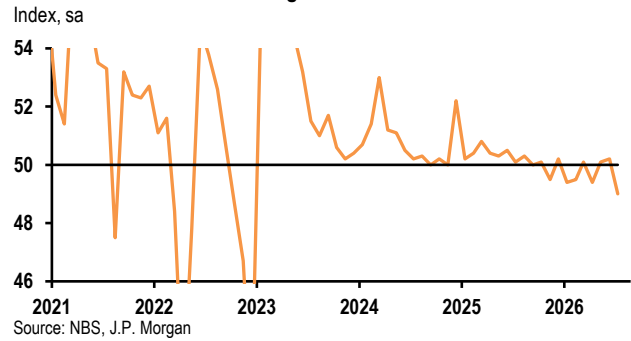
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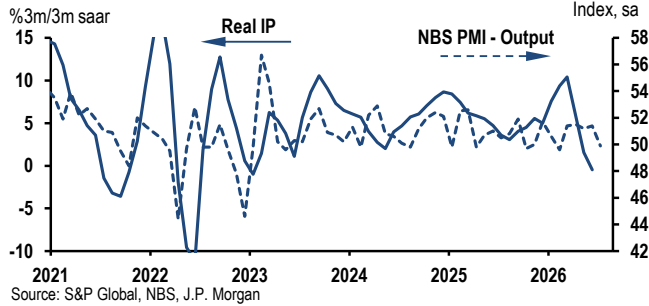
### China: Manufacturing PMIs



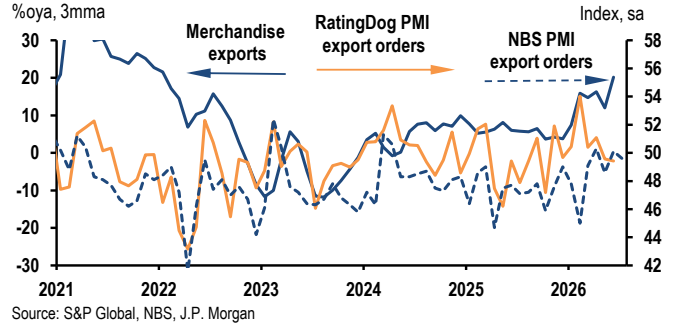
### China NBS non-manufacturing PMI



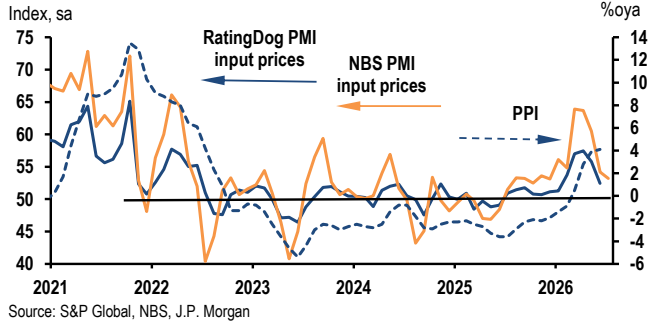
### China: IP and manufacturing PMI output



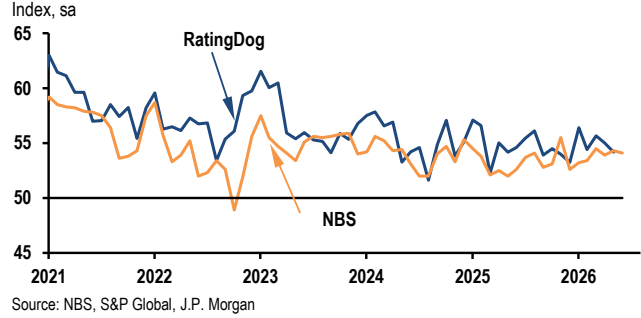
### China: manufacturing PMI export orders and merchandise exports



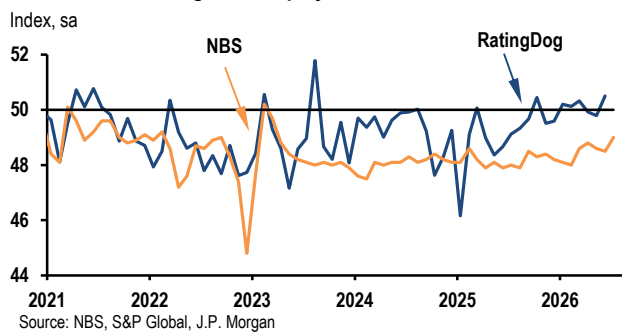
### China: PPI and manufacturing PMI input prices



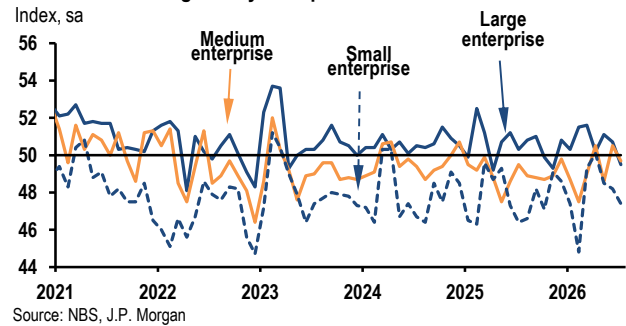
### China: Manufacturing future output PMIs



### China: Manufacturing PMI - employment



### NBS manufacturing PMI by enterprise size



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